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THE KING'S LODGE

Hebrew Poetry and Psalms

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Part 3

Hebrew Poetry: Other Poetic Devices

Climactic (or Staircase) Parallelism

- Climactic Parallelism combines synonymous and formal parallelism
- The second line echoes part of the first line, then adds a phrase that develops the meaning and completes the sense

Climactic (or Staircase) Parallelism

- Ps 29:1-2
- Ascribe to the Lord, O heavenly beings,
- Ascribe to the Lord <u>glory and strength</u>.

Climactic (or Staircase) Parallelism

- Ps 93:3
- The floods have lifted up, O Lord,
- The floods have lifted up <u>their voice</u>.

Climactic (or Staircase) Parallelism

- Ex 15:6
- Thy right hand, O Lord, glorious in power,
- Thy right hand, O Lord, <u>shatters the enemy</u>.

Chiasm

- This is a variation of Synonymous Parallelism
- Some Synonymous Parallel verses have a chiastic structure in the line phrases or in the lines

Chiasm In The Phrases

- Psalm 22:10
- On you was I cast[a] from my birth[b],
- and from my mother's womb[b1] you have been my God[a1]

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Chiasm In The Phrases

- Psalm 22:22
- I will tell of your name[a] to my brothers[b];
- in the midst of the congregation[b1] I will praise you[a1]

Chiasm In The Phrases

- Psalm 22:22
- I will tell of your name[a] to my brothers[b];
- in the midst of the congregation[b1] I will praise you[a1]

Chiasm In The Phrases

- Psalm 22:22
- I will tell of your name[a] to my brothers[b];
- in the midst of the congregation[b1] I will praise you[a1]

Chiasm In The Phrases

- Psalm 22:22
- I will tell of your name[a] to my brothers[b];
- in the midst of the congregation[b1] I will praise you[a1]

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- Psalm 22:22
- I will tell of your name[a] to my brothers[b];
- in the midst of the congregation[b1] I will praise you[a1]

Chiasm In The Phrases

- Psalm 22:22
- I will tell of your name[a] to my brothers[b];
- in the midst of the congregation[b1] I will praise you[a1]

Chiasm In The Phrases (Tristich or Triplet)

- Psalm 22:23
- You who fear the Lord[a], praise him[b]
- All you offspring of Jacob[a1], glorify him[b1],
- and stand in awe of him[b2], all you offspring of Israel[a2]

Chiasm In The Phrases (Tristich or Triplet)

- Psalm 22:23
- You who fear the Lord[a], praise him[b]
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Chiasm In The Lines

- With Chiasm in the lines, each couplet would seem to be formal parallelism
- But when two couplets are seen together there is a chiastic structure between them

Chiasm In The Lines

- Ps 31:3 (Formal Parallelism)

- You are indeed my rock and my fortress;
- for your name's sake lead me and guide me,

Chiasm In The Lines

- Ps 31:4 (Formal Parallelism)

- take me out of the net hidden for me,
- for you are my refuge.

Chiasm In The Lines

- Ps 31:3-4

- You are indeed my rock and my fortress;
- for your name's sake lead me and guide me,
- take me out of the net hidden for me,
- for you are my refuge.

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Chiasm In The Lines

- Ps 31:3-4

- A You are indeed my rock and my fortress;
- B for your name's sake lead me and guide me,
- B take me out of the net hidden for me,
- A for you are my refuge.

Chiasm

- Ps 51:1 (two couplets of Formal Parallelism)

- Have mercy on me O God
- according to your steadfast love
- according to your abundant mercy
- blot out my transgression

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Chiasm

- Ps 51:1

- A Have mercy on me O God
- B according to your steadfast love
- B according to your abundant mercy
- A blot out my transgression

Chiasm In Lines

- Is 6:10:
- A Make the heart of this people fat.
- B and their ears heavy,
- C and shut their eyes;
- C lest they see with their eyes,
- B and hear with their ears,
- A and understand with their hearts,
- and turn and be healed.

Refrain

- A refrain is where there is a repeated phrase or verse
- The repetition is for effect and emphasis

Refrain

- Ps 67:3, 5
- Let the peoples praise you, O God;
- Let all the peoples praise you.

Refrain

- Ps. 80:3, 7, 19
- Restore us, O God; let your face shine, that we may be saved.

Refrain

- Job 28:12, 20
- But where shall wisdom be found?
- And where is the place of understanding?

Inclusio

- Inclusio is when there is a correspondence between, or repetition of, the beginning and the end of the Psalm

Inclusio

- Ps 103:1 + 22
- Bless the Lord O my soul

Inclusio

- Psalm 118:1 and 29
- Oh give thanks to the LORD, for he is good;
- for his steadfast love endures forever!

Key Word Repetition

- Key Word Repetition is when a word is repeated providing an emphasis in the poem

Key Word Repetition

- The noun “voice” in Psalm 29
- The verb “keep” (NRSV) in Psalm 121

Acrostic Poetry

- First letter of each line, taken together, forms a recognizable pattern
- Lines begin with the letters of the Hebrew alphabet in order

Acrostic Poetry

- Psalm 119 each eight verses begin with the same letter of the alphabet
- Other acrostic Psalms are 9, 10, 25, 34, 37, 111, 112, 145
- Lamentations chapters 1-4

Ellipsis (Synonymous Parallelism)

- An ellipsis is another variation of Synonymous Parallelism
- It is when an element of one line is omitted
- But, understood to apply also to the second line

Ellipsis

- Ps 103:7

- He made known his ways to Moses,
- his acts to the people of Israel.

Ellipsis

- Ps 103:7

- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
- Ø his acts[b1] to the people of Israel[c1].

Ellipsis

- Ps 103:7

- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
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- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
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- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
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- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
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Ellipsis

- Ps 103:7

- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
- Ø his acts[b1] to the people of Israel[c1].

Ellipsis

- Ps 103:7

- With out an ellipsis it might read:
- He made known[a] his ways[b] to Moses[c],
- He declared[a] his acts[b1] to the people of Israel[c1]

Ellipsis

- Ps 105:10

- Which he confirmed to Jacob as a statute,
- to Israel as an everlasting covenant.

Ellipsis

- Ps 105:10

- Which he confirmed[a] to Jacob[b] as a statute[c],
- Ø to Israel[b1] as an everlasting covenant[c1].

Ellipsis

- Ps 105:10

- Which he confirmed[a] to Jacob[b] as a statute[c],
- Ø to Israel[b1] as an everlasting covenant[c1].

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- Ps 105:10

- Which he confirmed[a] to Jacob[b] as a statute[c],
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Merismus

- Merismus describes the poetic device of using two extremes to express a totality

Merismus

- Ps 95:4

- In his hands are the **depths** of the earth;
- The **heights** of the mountains are his also.

Merismus

- Ps 95:5

- The **sea** is his, for he made it,
- And the **dry land**, which his hands formed.

Study Symbols

- Synonymous Parallelism ⇒
- Antithetic Parallelism → ←
- Synthetic or FormalParallelism →
- Staircase Parallelism ↗ ↗

Study Symbols

- Chiasm or Chiastic Parallelism X

or A,B,C,B,A

- Refrain ♪V? + V?
- Inclusio [v?+v?]

Study Symbols

- Ellipsis Ø
- Merismus ↔